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I Don't Recognize This **Body.**

Making peace with the body that
made your babies.

START HERE

You catch your reflection and a stranger looks back.

Softer. Marked. Heavier or emptier in places you don't remember. You dress to hide it, flinch at photos, and scroll past "bounce back" posts feeling like your body is something that went wrong.

It didn't go wrong. It did the single most extraordinary thing a body can do. This isn't about "fixing" yourself or loving every inch by Friday — it's about stopping the war, and making a quiet peace with the body you actually live in.

THE REFRAME

Your body isn't ruined. It's changed — because it grew, birthed, and maybe fed a whole human being. That's not damage. That's a record.

STEP 1

You're allowed to grieve the old body

"Be grateful, you have a baby!" — and you are. AND you can still miss the body you had. Both are true. Don't shame the grief; name it.

- The body that fit your old clothes without thinking.
- The version of you that felt at home in her own skin.
- The ease of not having to brace before a mirror or a photo.

What I miss about my old body / self:

Grief and gratitude can share the same heart. Letting yourself feel the loss is how you stop fighting it.

STEP 2

What this body actually did

Read this slowly, like it's about someone you love — because it is. Your body:

- Built a human being from scratch. Organs, fingerprints, a heartbeat.
- Stretched, opened, and brought them safely here.
- Maybe fed and soothed them with nothing but itself.
- Carried you both through the hardest, most sleepless season of your life.

Those marks are not flaws. They're the map of where your child came from. A body that did all that has earned softness — not your contempt.

STEP 3

Unfollow the lie

You're not failing — you're being lied to, all day, by your own phone. Clean the inputs:

- **Unfollow "bounce back."** Mute the before/after, the 6-week-flat-stomach accounts, the filters.
- **Follow real bodies.** Postpartum-honest creators, mixed sizes, no airbrush. Retrain your "normal."
- **Name the edit.** That flawless feed is lighting, posing, and filters — not a body you're losing to.
- **Comparison detox.** 24 hours off the apps that make you flinch. Notice how you feel.

3 accounts I'll mute or unfollow today:

Neutral first, then kind

You don't have to leap to "I love my body." That pressure backfires. Aim lower and truer first: **neutral and respectful.**

- **From "I hate my stomach" to "this is my stomach."** Just a body part, not a verdict.
- **Thank it for function.** "These legs carried groceries and a toddler today." Respect what it does.
- **Dress the body you have** — clothes that fit and feel good now, not the goal-jeans in the drawer.
- **Move for joy, not punishment.** A walk because it feels good, never to "earn" food or "fix" yourself.

Make peace.

Say them to the woman in the mirror. She needs to hear it:

- My body is not a problem to be solved.
- I can miss my old body and still respect this one.
- These changes are proof of love, not failure.
- I will not pass body-hate down to my children.
- I am allowed to take up space, exactly as I am today.

One kind thing I'll say to my body this week:

If food, exercise, or body thoughts feel obsessive or out of control, that's worth gentle help — please talk to your doctor or a therapist.

This body didn't fail you. It made your whole world.

Grieve what changed, then look again — this time with the tenderness it has earned. You don't have to love every inch today. You just have to stop the war. Make peace. She's worth it.

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